Section 4: Ticket Priority and Severity Classification

Purpose

The purpose of this classification system is to establish consistent guidelines for prioritizing IT support requests based on business impact and urgency.

Priority Levels

HIGH PRIORITY

Description: Issues that significantly affect an employee's ability to work, interrupt important business operations, or potentially create security risks.

Examples:

- Employee account locked and unable to access essential systems.
- Network connectivity outage affecting business operations.
- Suspicious phishing email requiring security investigation.
- Widespread email service disruption.

Expected Response: Immediate assessment and prompt troubleshooting or escalation according to organizational policy.

MEDIUM PRIORITY

Description: Issues that affect productivity but have available workarounds or do not completely prevent business operations.

Examples:

- Printer not responding.
- Computer running slowly.
- Forgotten password with an available recovery process.
- Monitor displaying no signal when alternative equipment is available.

Expected Response: Address within the organization's established support timeframe.

LOW PRIORITY

Description: Non-urgent requests that have minimal impact on daily operations.

Examples:

- Routine software installation requests.
- External keyboard replacement when another keyboard is available.
- General software configuration assistance.

Expected Response: Schedule resolution according to the support team's workload and service-level agreements.

Ticket Prioritization Factors

IT support technicians should consider:

1. Business Impact: How many employees or business operations are affected?
2. Urgency: How quickly does the issue need to be resolved?
3. Security Risk: Could the issue involve unauthorized access, malware, or data exposure?
4. Work Availability: Can the employee continue working using an alternative solution?